

1.8 Methods for Improving HCI

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CS XII

Chapter 1: Computer Systems (HCI)

Lecture 11 of 16

1.8 Methods for Improving HCI

LEARN IT

Once you can name an HCI problem, you fix it with a matching method. The source lists eight methods. Learn each with its tiny example — they pair almost one-to-one with Section 1.7.

- **Enhance usability:** simplify navigation (a clear "Buy Now" button).
- **Strengthen accessibility:** support disabilities (captions on videos).
- **Ensure consistency:** keep layouts uniform (the same "Save" button everywhere).
- **Provide clear feedback:** show action results ("Payment Successful" popup).
- **Improve adaptability:** responsive design (the website scales to mobile screens).
- **Apply user-centred design (UCD):** focus on real user goals and pilot-test.
- **Use multimodal interaction:** allow touch, voice or gesture inputs combined.
- **Continuous testing:** regularly update based on user feedback.

User-centred design (UCD) means the real user's goals drive every decision, and you trial (pilot-test) the design with those users instead of guessing in an office.

Responsive design means the layout rearranges itself for phone, tablet and PC, instead of staying a laptop-only page.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked example: match each JazzCash / portal problem to a fix.

Problem (1.7)	Method (1.8)
Cannot find "Send Money"	Enhance usability — one clear button
No captions on help video	Strengthen accessibility
Search icon changes from page to page	Ensure consistency
Submit freezes with no message	Clear feedback — "Payment Successful"
Portal crashes on mobile	Improve adaptability — responsive layout
Built features nobody asked for	UCD — interview, then pilot-test
Elderly user cannot type a long number	Multimodal — voice + touch
Complaints ignored after launch	Continuous testing and updates

REMEMBER IT

Think "problem → method" as a pair. Complexity ↔ usability. No captions ↔ accessibility. Different icons ↔ consistency. Freeze ↔ feedback. Phone crash ↔ adaptability. Guessing ↔ UCD. One input only ↔ multimodal. Launch and forget ↔ continuous testing.

COMMON MISTAKE

Mistake: Naming methods without saying *what they change* ("we will improve HCI" is not an answer).

Fix: Always attach the source example: "Provide clear feedback, for example a Payment Successful popup."

اردو میں سمجھیں

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CHECK YOURSELF

1. What does UCD stand for, and what extra step does it include?
2. Which method stops a website from failing on a phone?
3. Give the source's example of clear feedback.

Answers: 1. User-Centred Design; focus on real user goals and pilot-test. 2. Improve adaptability (responsive design). 3. A "Payment Successful" popup.

Next lecture: 1.9 User Interface Design (UI vs UX)